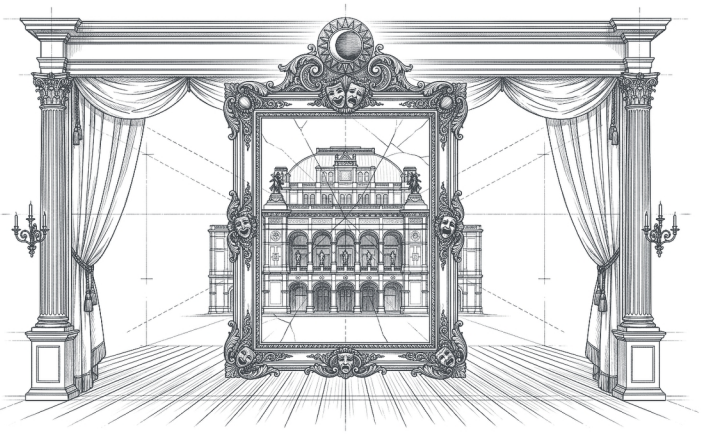
The Stage of the Mirror Speaker

The centre of the stage is cleared. In the grand Venetian frame, eight fragments of mirror already rest. When the ninth piece is laid into the glass, the cracks heal and the true reflection awakens.

Gather the marks from the margins of Sheets 19 to 26. In order, they reveal the words of the ceremony. Look deep into the restored glass: it does not reflect this underground hall, but a great palace of music five hundred leagues to the north. Count the five arches of its loggia; let the restored reflection speak its name when the ninth piece is laid in the frame.

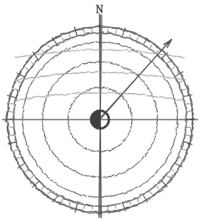


The Liturgy of the Mirror Speaker

"You did not seek an echo, Silvia; you sought an awakening. The nine shards were scattered through the gloom so that only hands that honour symmetry could heal what fire tried to sever. Now look deep into the glass: across five hundred leagues of mountain and river, the grand hall of the imperial capital awaits, where the stone dances and the strings are tuned to your arrival. Walk into the snow with an untroubled heart. The mirror never forgets what it has once reflected."

– The Mirror Speaker

The Celestial Meridian of the 48th Parallel



Meridian Dial · 48° 12′ N

Astrometric Sighting · Imperial Basin

Zenith Latitude: 48° 12′ 12″ N · Imperial Meridian: 16° 22′ 08″ E

True Bearing: 354° North through the Alpine Pass · Elevation: 171 m

Hermes: The line is true. From the proscenium of Tower III, the sighting line passes directly over the high shoulder of Tower I and descends into the imperial valley. The raiders flee along our exact meridian. At first light, we pack the instruments and ride toward the snow.

H. & A.

Back to the Peaks

The Stage Path is finished. The restored glass has spoken, casting its true reflection northward across five hundred leagues to the imperial palace of music. Yet our journey cannot rest while the Astrolabe remains lost to the ashes.

At first light we pack the sighting instruments, strap the brass cases to the mules, and step out from the underground proscenium into the sharp alpine dawn. Aurelia has released the white dove toward the crags of Tower I to announce our ascent. Ahead lies the Chasm Pass, where the ancient road climbs to the secret convergence of the Three Towers.



Bearings: 354° North from Tower III through the Chasm Pass toward Tower I and the Vault. — H. & A.